

BUILD PLAN — Curator information architecture redesign

- **Project:** mini-moi · personal-ai-agents · Curator domain
 - **Authored:** 2026-06-04 13:54 CDT (18:54 UTC) — Claude.ai, design
 - **Status:** QUEUED — register for later. Do not start build this session.
 - **Branch (proposed):** `feat/curator-ia` off `main` (NOT `guild`) — that's spine work; NOT `main` directly)
 - **Handoff:** Claude.ai authored → Grok review pass recommended → Claude Code implements + commits → Robert confirms before every push
 - **Scope (one line):** Reorganize Curator into six pages on a pipeline spine, split the overloaded "Research" tab, fold Observations into Leanings, and ship the four-button landing with fixed evergreen copy.
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1 — Purpose

Today's Curator nav muddles three jobs across shared surfaces. Two specific tangles:

1. **"Research" does two jobs at once** — it holds both the *artifacts* (scans, dives) and the *config* (what topics/threads are tracked). Output you browse vs. a control panel you set.
2. **Library and Archive overlap** because they're split on the wrong axis (kind-of-thing) instead of the right one (active vs. permanent).

The fix is to let the existing tagline be the navigation:

┆ targeted search → analysis → opinion/doubt → long-term archive

Each stage becomes a room; one control surface (the Desk) sits off the flow because it *steers* the machine rather than being part of it.

2 — Locked decisions (this session)

- **Six pages in Curator:** Daily · Reading Room · Scans & Dives · Leanings · Archive · Desk.
- **Library → Reading Room.** Active working set: saved articles flagged to read or act on, with Read / Scan / Dive actions.
- **Archive** = the permanent, searchable record. Split from Reading Room on the active-vs-permanent axis; an item graduates from Reading Room to Archive once handled.
- **"Research" tab splits:** artifacts → Scans & Dives; config (Topics, Sources, Groups, research threads, tag aliases) → Desk.

- **AI Observations → Leanings** (a strip inside Leanings; the AI's reads sit next to your positions). The standalone Observations tab is retired.
- **Focus → Desk** if/when it is built (it's the attention lever, same family as Topics). Not building Focus now.
- **Daily keeps its name.**
- **Landing page = four entry buttons**, not all six. Buttons: Daily · Scans & Dives · Leanings · Archive. The front-page research entry is Scans & Dives (the alive output); the Desk is an in-app destination only. Reading Room and Desk are reachable from the in-app top nav.
- **Landing card bodies:** counts/details removed; fixed evergreen copy now (see §6). This is the version that ships and gets screenshotted for the public GitHub repo.

3 — Open decisions (need Robert before build)

- **Landing background image.** Options reviewed: A hero-shadow-10 (bookshop/street), B hero-shadow-11 (neoclassical hall), or none. Recommendation: **B** — radial fade keeps the cleanest area under the masthead and cards, texture pushed to margins. Not yet confirmed. (Check card-strip legibility on the live render at full resolution before locking.)

4 — Target IA

Top nav order (follows the pipeline; Desk set apart on the right):

Daily · Reading Room · Scans & Dives · Leanings · Archive Desk

Pipeline mapping:

Stage	Room
intake (targeted search)	Daily
triage	Reading Room
analysis	Scans & Dives
opinion / doubt	Leanings
long-term archive	Archive
<i>control (off the flow)</i>	Desk

Object → home (one home each, nothing orphaned):

Object	Home
Source (saved article)	Reading Room (active) → Archive (retired)
Scan	Scans & Dives → Archive
Dive (thread)	Scans & Dives → Archive
Leaning	Leanings
Observation	Leanings (strip)
Topic, Group, research thread, tag_aliases, Focus	Desk
Note	attached to whatever it annotates

5 — Page specs

JSON remains source of truth for every page (Postgres/Neo4j are a rebuildable projection; daily use never depends on the DB).

Daily — keep as-is. Today's scored briefing (top 20 to portal, top 10 to Telegram). No structural change.

Reading Room (was Library) — the active saved set. Same table content as today's Library (Date, Title & Note, Source, Category, Score, Type, Actions), filters (All / Liked / Saved / X Posts / categories). Rename only for this build; the active-vs-permanent lifecycle (items graduating to Archive) is a follow-on, not required for v1.

Scans & Dives — keep page; confirm it surfaces all research artifacts that were reachable under the old "Research" tab. Dives (THREAD objects: sessions · sources · cost) and Scans listed as today.

Leanings — standalone page. Question → Lean → Hold gradient with evidence and AI teammate reads. **Add an Observations strip** (AI's unprompted reads) sourced from the existing observations JSON. No AI inference triggered on page load.

Archive (new) — unified, searchable, read-only browse with sections: Daily editions · Scans · Dives · Observations · retired Sources. Search across time. Reads existing JSON; no new data model.

Desk (new) — the control surface. Manage Topics (state machine: active-pull / dormant-on-radar / one-shot), Sources/feeds, Groups, research threads, tag aliases (currently headless — keep so

unless a thin UI is wanted). Focus lands here later. This is where threads are *set up* (a control action), distinct from Scans & Dives where finished work is *read*.

Landing — masthead + four-card catalog. Background per §3. Card copy per §6. Tagline retained: *targeted search* → *analysis* → *opinion/doubt* → *long-term archive*. Buttons link Daily / Scans & Dives / Leanings / Archive.

6 — Landing card copy (FIXED, ships now)

Per-card body = kicker (mono, uppercase) + line (serif) + link (accent, mono, uppercase). No live data, no counts, evergreen, takes no position — safe for a public repo screenshot.

Card	Kicker	Line	Link
Daily	Daily briefing	The day's stories, scored and ranked by morning.	Today ›
Scans & Dives	Research	Where a quick read becomes a deep dive.	Explore ›
Leanings	Working views	Open questions, held until the evidence lands.	Review ›
Archive	The stacks	Everything kept, and searchable over time.	Browse ›

Design tokens (existing system, do not invent new ones):

- nav (■ #2A1F14) · parchment (□ #F5F0E8) · card (□ #EDE7DC) · accent (■ #C68A5E) · border (■ #C4B49A)
- muted text (■ #8A7060) / (■ #A89880)
- Georgia serif for headlines/titles; monospace for tabs, kickers, dates, links
- card tab bar: dark (■ #2A1F14), mono uppercase, letter-spacing ~0.14em

7 — Migration map (old → new)

Old	New
Daily	Daily (unchanged)
Library	Reading Room (rename)
Scans & Dives	Scans & Dives (absorbs artifacts surfaced under old Research)

Old	New
Observations / AI Observations	folded into Leanings (strip); standalone tab retired
Research	split: artifacts → Scans & Dives; config (Topics/Sources/Groups/threads/tags) → Desk; Leanings → its own page
Priorities (legacy)	already replaced by Investigate modal; no page
Focus button	→ Desk (deferred)
—	Archive (new unified browse)
—	Desk (new control surface)

Add temporary redirects from old routes (`/library`, `/research`, `/observations`) to new homes so nothing breaks mid-migration; remove only after the new nav is confirmed.

8 — Build sequence (phased; test gate + Robert sign-off per phase)

Bones first — put the page containers in before moving content into them.

1. **Landing page.** Build from `_working/curator-landing-build-spec.md`, refined by §6 (fixed copy) and §3 (background pick). Run `tools/capture_screenshots.py`. Robert visual sign-off → push. *(This is the most self-contained piece and the one that screenshots for GitHub.)*
2. **Six-tab nav scaffold.** Introduce new nav order + empty/placeholder Archive and Desk routes. Old pages still reachable via redirects. Test routes (curl/200s). Screenshot. Sign-off.
3. **Rename + fold.** Library → Reading Room. Observations strip into Leanings (read existing JSON). Retire standalone Observations tab. Test. Sign-off.
4. **Split Research.** Route artifacts to Scans & Dives; move Topics/Sources/Groups/threads/tags config to Desk. Test. Sign-off.
5. **Archive page.** Wire the unified browse sections from existing JSON. Test. Sign-off.
6. **Cleanup.** Remove dead routes/redirects after the new nav is confirmed stable.

Each phase tests what's testable (curl, pytest, direct invocation). Robert tests UI flows end-to-end. No phase merges to `main` until Robert confirms. Re-run the screenshot baseline at the end.

9 — Definition of done

- All six pages reachable from the new nav; landing shows four buttons with the §6 copy.
 - Old routes redirect (then are removed in phase 6); nothing 404s mid-migration.
 - Observations visible inside Leanings; no standalone Observations tab.
 - Topics/Sources/Groups/threads live on the Desk; artifacts on Scans & Dives.
 - Daily briefing pipeline and Telegram delivery unaffected (regression-checked).
 - Screenshot baseline re-captured and committed to `docs/screenshots/curator/current/`.
 - If a step can't be tested, that is stated explicitly — not committed and claimed done.
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10 — Deferred / v2 (write the note now so it isn't forgotten)

- **Live teaser headlines on landing cards.** Pull the *latest item* per room from existing JSON (no background inference — fits "spend follows attention"). Replaces the fixed §6 copy on the three living rooms; Archive can show a live count.
 - **Gate (required before v2 ships):** a sanitization rule for what is allowed to surface on a public/guest-facing surface — no charged or sensitive items on the front door. Guest search stays generic.
 - Reading Room active-vs-permanent lifecycle (items auto-graduating to Archive).
 - Optional thin UI for tag aliases on the Desk.
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11 — Guardrails

- **Branch discipline:** `main` stays production-stable; do this on `feat/curator-ia`; do not merge until Robert signs off.
 - **JSON is source of truth;** DB not a dependency for any of this.
 - **Test-before-commit;** Robert confirms before every push on visual/production-touching changes.
 - **One agent active at a time.** Claude Code owns all git.
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12 — Git action for now

Claude Code (via OpenClaw command) to commit this plan as a queued artifact — work itself deferred:

```
git add _working/BUILD_PLAN_curator-ia-redesign_2026-06-04_1354.md
git commit -m "plan: queue Curator IA redesign (six-page model, four-button
landing, fixed copy)"
```

Suggested repo location: `_working/`. Branch creation (`feat/curator-ia`) is deferred to build time, not now.

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